



Apple hires Samsung exec

Apple has poached the head of Samsung's battery division to lead its own battery development efforts. <https://digit.in/feb19-27>



All display fingerprint sensor

Vivo Apex 2019 is a smartphone with no ports and speakers however its USP being an all display fingerprint sensor. <https://digit.in/feb19-28>

TrueConnect, without sounding overly biased towards warmth. These buds sound lively across the sound spectrum without tiring you out. The bass sounds deep without being overbearing, the mids come across as clear, the highs sound energetic - and the combination makes it comfortable to listen to for hours. Far from being neutral, these earbuds are more focussed on pumping bass in a way that is fun and caters to a wide audio preference. As with earbuds enabled with a bass bump, the highs are the weakest aspect and can get a bit harsh with particular instruments.

Verdict: There's a lot to nitpick with the RHA TrueConnect when it comes to features, or rather their lack thereof. For instance, there's no aptX support, no ambient noise features that are present in counterparts from companies like Jabra. However, the TrueConnect uses its build and audio performance to compensate for that. They are also way more reliable in terms of connectivity and battery backup. Additionally, the TrueConnect feels premium due to its finish. This could be the best pair of true wireless earbuds you can get at its price point.

JABRA ELITE ACTIVE 65T

Build and design: The Elite 65t is compact and inconspicuous. The fit is brilliant and we never experienced any discomfort or the fear of it falling out. The buds managed an impressive near 6-hour battery life in our tests and the case brings the total up to a massive 17 hours. However, the case could open more smoothly than it does. Features like HearThrough in Active Mode (available through the app) and step tracking along with an IPX6 rating make it a perfect sport upgrade to the Elite 65t.

Performance: If you've tried out the Elite 65t, nothing much has changed. You'll still find the same punchy, lively bass and the shimmering treble on the Active 65t. The mids are slightly repressed, but the overall sense of balance makes up for it in the final result. The good fit

with the right tips on these earbuds can provide a great sense of isolation and bring you a sound that is not just catered to workouts, but to general listening as well. The detail on the Active 65t is excellent.

Verdict: These earbuds offer a good combination of sound quality and fitness oriented features. The presence of ambient noise mode lets you keep track of your surroundings. They don't sound as well as, say, the SoundSport Free from Bose, but they definitely fit significantly better. Go for these earbuds if you're looking for strong bass, a good fit combined with inconspicuous yet thoughtful design.

PLANTRONICS BACKBEAT FIT 3100

Build and design: If there's any earbud on this entire list that comes across as blatantly as a sports earbud as the Bose SoundSport Free, it's the Plantronics Backbeat FIT 3100. There are large plastic ear-wings that protrude out of the circular buds to ensure a comfortable yet secure fit. The IPX7 rating makes them swim friendly, and the open design ensures that ambient noise seeps through, something that the SoundSport Free also does well. While Plantronics claims a five-hour battery life on these, we weren't able to cross four in our tests, which makes it lose you against competitors that last longer. In terms of control, Plantronics has gone half the distance by including touch-capacitive controls on the left earbud for volume control while the right earbud comes with a physical button for playback controls.

Performance: While the Backbeat FIT 3100 features the same focus on letting in ambient noise as the SoundSport Free, it doesn't come anywhere close in terms of audio quality. Bass makes its presence felt only if there's enough to be heard over the ambient noise. There's not enough clarity, and balance is an issue as well. While there's no distortion at higher volumes, we feel it is more due to the lack of power than due to performance excellence. Overall, the Plantronics

Backbeat FIT 3100 is pretty average in its sound quality.

Verdict: While specifically targeted at sports enthusiasts, the only area where the Backbeat FIT 3100 manages to supersede the SoundSport Free is the design - it doesn't protrude out of your ear as the Bose does. However, this is due to the prominent wings on the FIT 3100. On the other hand, the FIT 3100 doesn't come with the sound quality of the Bose either. It depends on what you prioritise.

B&O BEOPLAY E8

Build and design: Even before you get to the buds, it is the case that showcases their design skills with the oval, flat approach making it a comfortable fit into your pocket. Open the case and you see what could be the best designed earbud of this group quite easily. The slim profile of the E8 ensures that they do not stick too far out of your ears. The touch controls on both the buds are fabulous and seamless. The small build here makes it a bit irritating after a point to tap on, making it feel like the earbuds deep into your ear canals are being pushed even deeper. While there's no IP rating officially available for these buds, there's just not too many points for water to go into them in the design.

Performance: If the build was something that the Beoplay E8 shined on, it absolutely dazzled when it came to the audio performance. The audio was clean and crisp, without sounding flat. This is not a reference grade device and will never be one. However, the liveliness of the sound, with just the right amount of punch in the lower ends makes it an enjoyable experience to play your favourite tunes on the E8. The mids get significant presence, with vocals on tracks like Hello by Adele soaring at the height they deserve to. The highs are handled well too. The Beoplay E8 won the Zero1 Award 2018 for this category and that should be enough about its performance.

Verdict: According to B&O, these earbuds are currently retailing at ₹25000. The Beoplay E8 exudes class